WEEK 37 · 7–12 SEPTEMBER 2026

2027 Data and Engineering Delivery Plan

Week 37 Delivery Report

What moved this week, initiative by initiative, with the delivery schedule it sits in.

Cyber & Infra · Data · Core · Sector Intelligence · D&E · University Services

THE WEEK AT A GLANCE

Cyber & Infra 1 INITIATIVE

Outcomes. 1 initiatives moved, led by Strengthen Cyber Security. The cybersecurity analyst onboarding programme is now fully structured and under way, with a completed 30/60/90 plan and year-end objectives providing clear direction for capability growth within the security team.

Risks & decisions. Strengthen Cyber Security: Box configurations are highly interconnected and usage appears deeply embedded across business processes. Box configurations are highly interconnected. Current usage patterns appear deeply embedded across business processes.

Core 6 INITIATIVES

Outcomes. 6 initiatives moved, led by HIQ – QAS Auth Migration, MyQS CX – Ph 2, QAS Auth. QS Supergraph welcomes its new addition.

Risks & decisions. Customer account smart switching needs a decision. It resolves the confusion of customer accounts holding different subscriptions. QAS CX and HolonIQ user account migration QA is in progress — fixing subscription duplication, delta users and similar.

Sector Intelligence 4 INITIATIVES

Outcomes. 4 initiatives moved, led by QAS Stars, 1 Mentor IBM, MoveIN Smart Match / AI Email.

Risks & decisions. QAS Stars: QAS Stars data copy. Decision needed on how data copy will be handled on the new QAS Stars stack. Partnerships New: QPD back-office is inaccessible on live. Decision needed on where this will live. QPD back-office is inaccessible on live.

D&E 2 INITIATIVES

Outcomes. 2 initiatives moved, led by TU – Career Match Microsite, TU Performance & Upgrade. The site's quiz data now has a real technical block against bots and scrapers, not just an advisory signal, closing the gap flagged last week where a crawler ignoring the rules could still reach the data directly.

Risks & decisions. TU – Career Match Microsite: Microsite moving to urgent-only mode. Starting next week, the Microsite pod addresses only urgent and priority items; no further general feature work is queued. TU Performance & Upgrade: new servers testing continues.

University Services 3 INITIATIVES

Outcomes. 3 initiatives moved, led by Appian to Hubspot Migration, Decommission Informatica, Uni Services – Productivity Dashboards. QS Supergraph welcomes its new addition.

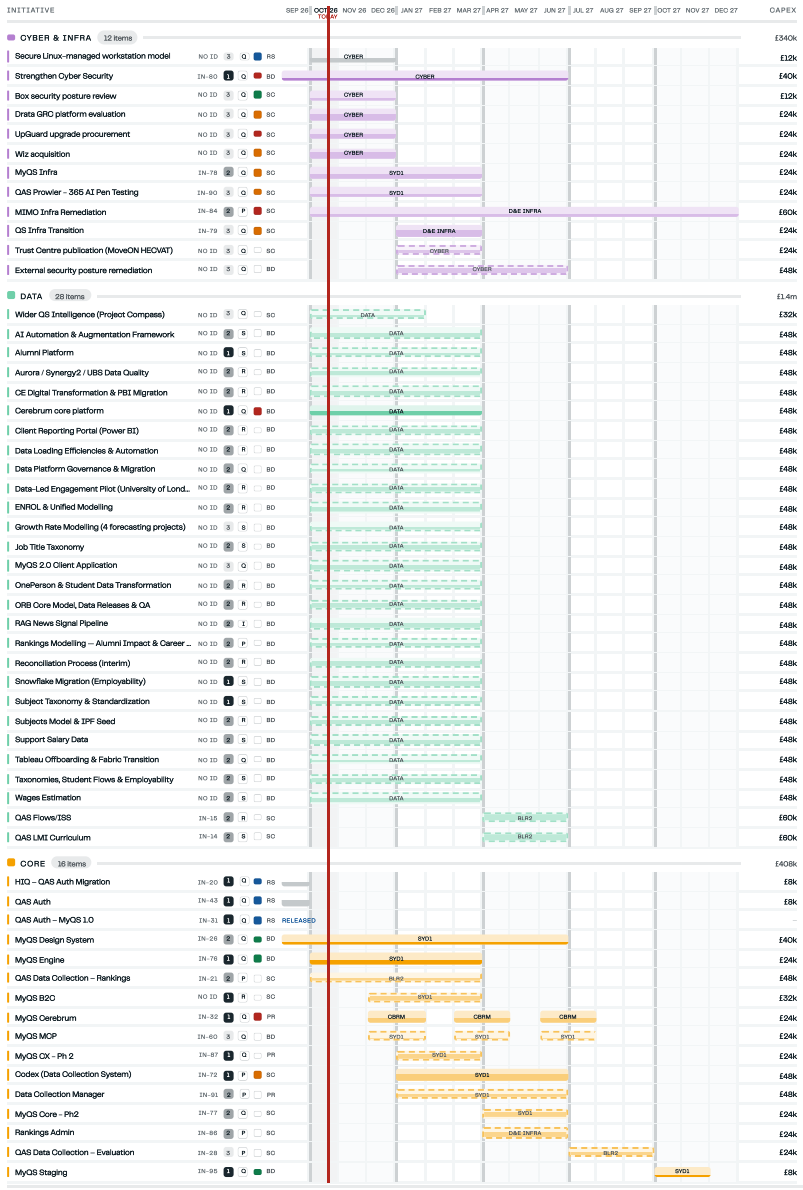
Risks & decisions. Appian to Hubspot Migration: HubSpot Contact Matching unavailable in test. Full integration testing cannot proceed until Contact Matching is available in the test environment. Decommission Informatica: Informatica contract ends 22 December 2026.

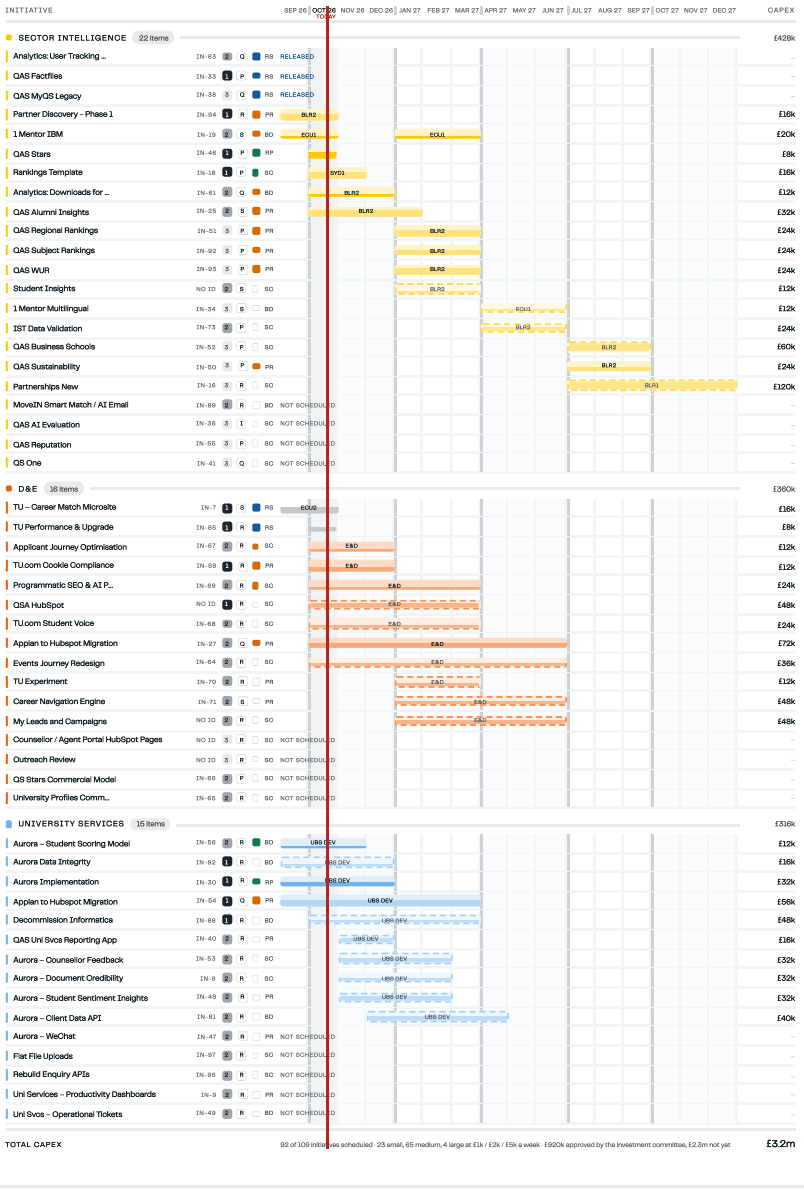
Contents

Delivery schedule 3
Engineering activity 4
Cyber & Infra 5
Core 7
Sector Intelligence 10
D&E 14
University Services 17

2027 Data and Engineering Delivery Plan

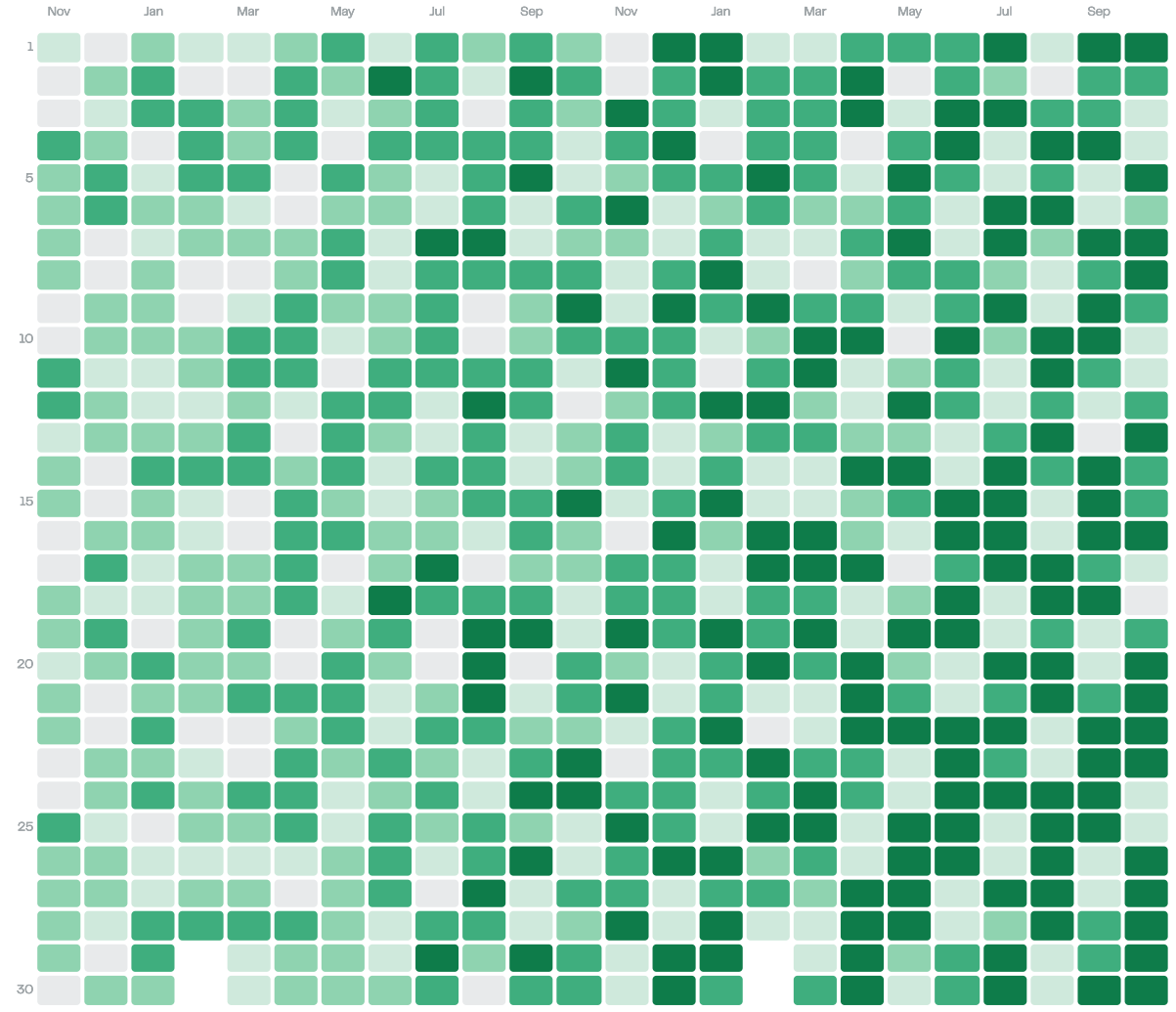
Delivery schedule 109 initiatives





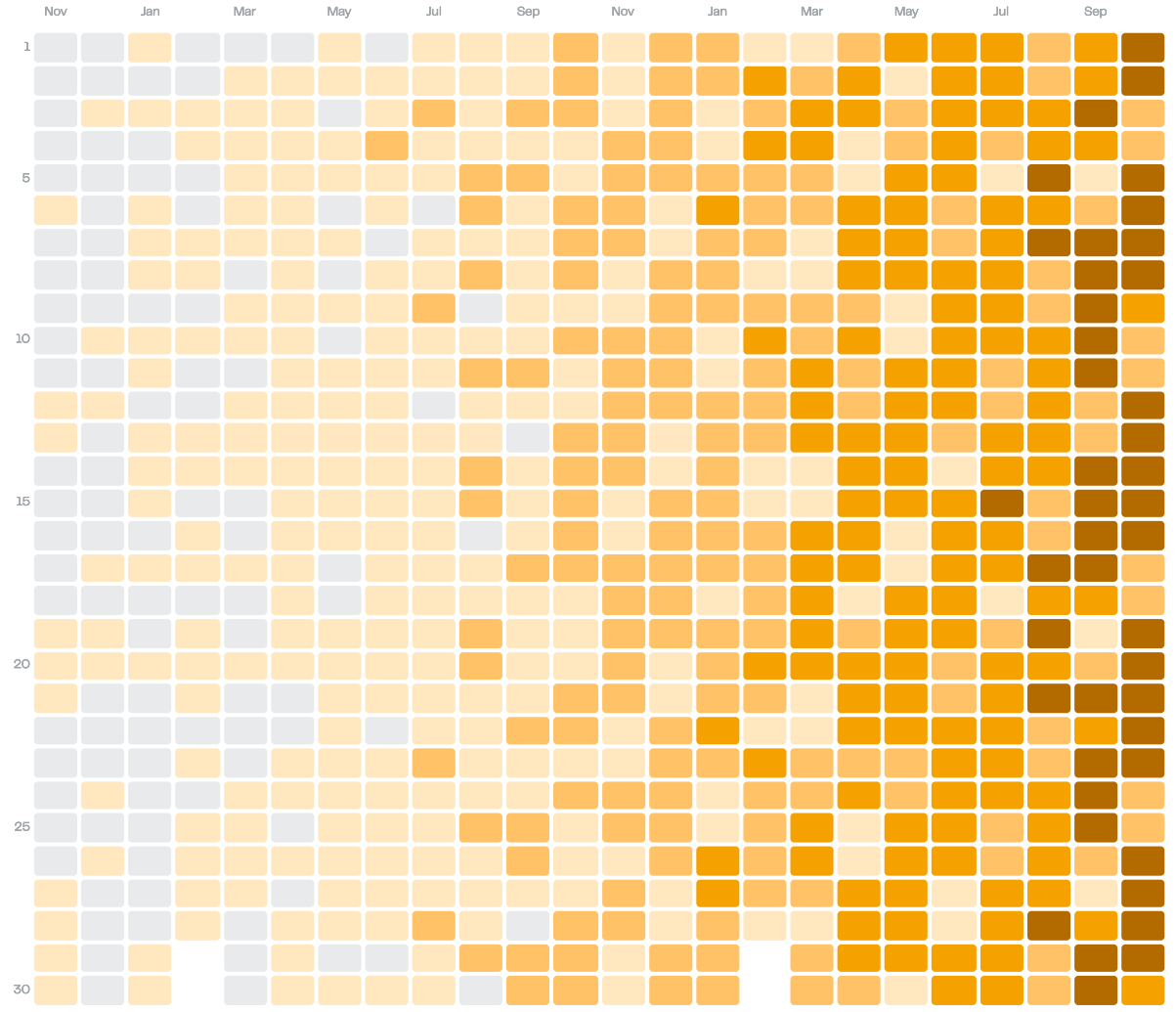
Productivity Heatmap NOV 24 – OCT 26

Lines of code committed a day.



AI Code Intensity NOV 24 – OCT 26

Share of committed code written by AI.

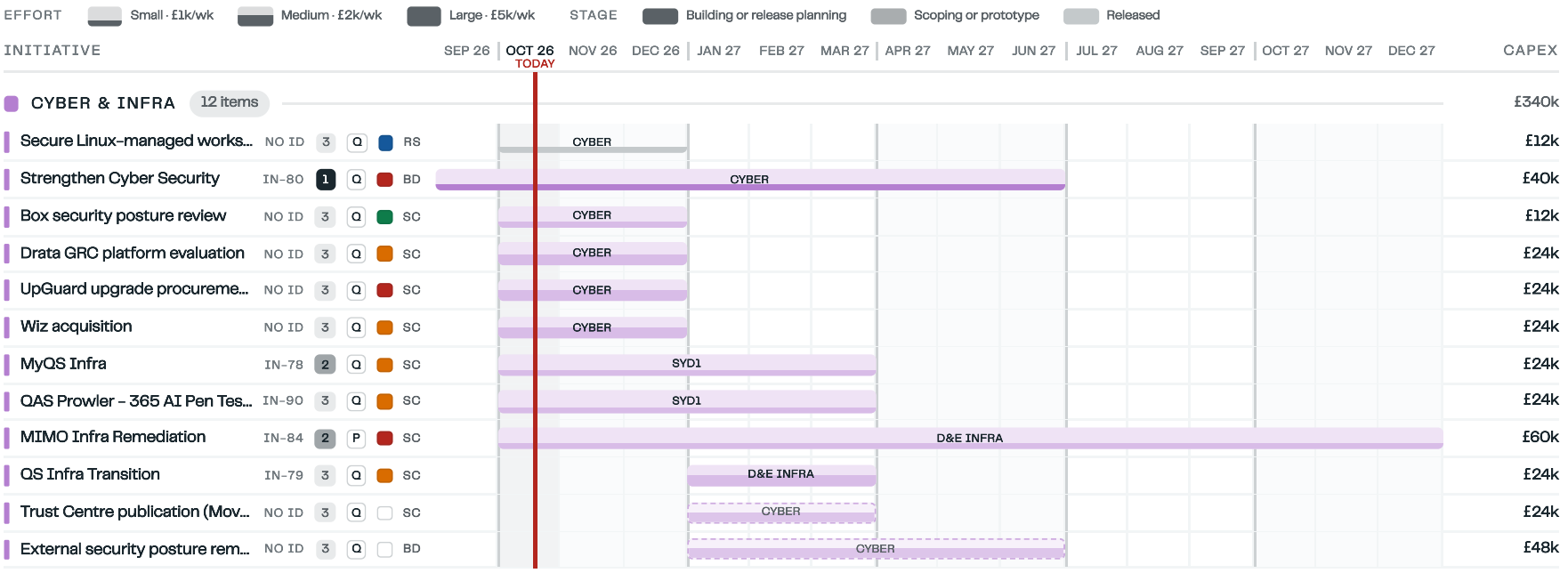


SECTION 1 OF 5

Cyber & Infra

1 initiative reported

1 building



TOTAL CAPEX — 12 of 12 initiatives scheduled · 6 small, 6 medium at £1k / £2k / £5k a week · £268k approved by the investment committee, £72k not yet — £340k

Strengthen Cyber Security

IN-80 · CYBER · CYBER · ROWAN CHAPMAN · BUILDING

Drata GRC PoV, vendor risk management procurement, cybersecurity posture management procurement, CrowdStrike AI security PoV, IT helpdesk evaluation, Box security posture review. Continued the proof of value, with a focus on policy management capabilities and assessing how the platform can improve governance, compliance and audit readiness across the organisation. HyperProof evaluation to follow. Worked with Procurement and key stakeholders to progress acquisition discussions for a vendor risk management solution to strengthen third-party risk oversight and support supplier due diligence processes. Advanced procurement and requirements discussions for a platform to improve visibility of organisational security posture and support ongoing risk reduction initiatives.

Risks and decisions. Box configurations are highly interconnected and usage appears deeply embedded across business processes. Desired security improvements, particularly around public sharing controls, may be constrained by existing processes and require larger organisational change.

Cyber

RISKS AND DECISIONS

Risks and decisions. Box configurations are highly interconnected. Current usage patterns appear deeply embedded across business processes. There is a risk that desired security improvements, particularly around public sharing controls, may be constrained by existing processes and require larger organisational change.

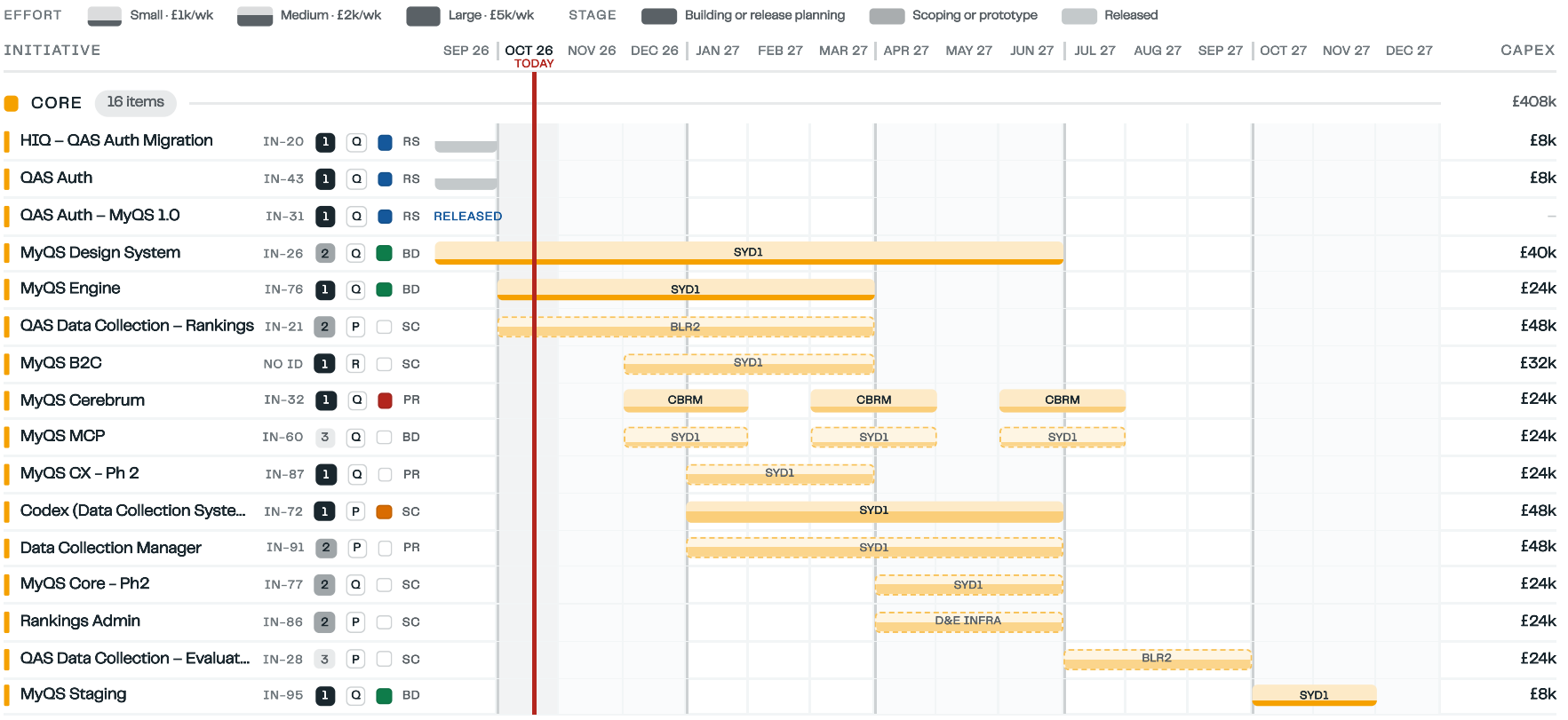
2027 Data and Engineering Delivery Plan

SECTION 2 OF 5

Core

6 initiatives reported

1 scoping
1 prototype
2 building
2 released



HIQ – QAS Auth Migration

IN-20 · SYD1 · SYD1 · CHARLIE LIU · RELEASED

ranking and reputation report header scroll fix promoted to qas-prod; import cycle breaks and Legacy Export added. Ranking and reputation report headers stick again while scrolling, promoted to qas-prod; two import cycles that crashed lazy routes were broken up, and Legacy Export was added to the Regional Rankings download menu; the hiq_internal sequence grant is recorded as applied on prod.

MyQS CX – Ph 2

IN-87 · SYD1 · SYD1 · CHARLIE LIU · QS APPLICATION SYSTEM · PROTOTYPE

CX FE (bulk add, QS IST tightened, CX product admin management, product_standard read-only); MyQS FE (subscription listing, No access revoke, access editor catalogue). The CX product admin can manage across the app, scoped to the current account, with product_standard strictly read-only; No access is offered as a revoke in the product role field; QS IST members are tightened to bulk add only, with the CX product grant able to override the carve-out; and Ming tiered QS-admin access by product_role in the Auth API. bulk add opened to its own grant end to end, QS IST tightened, the CX product admin managing everywhere and then scoped to the current account, product_standard read-only, and the Products badge counting active subscriptions only.

QAS Auth

IN-43 · SYD1 · SYD1 · CHARLIE LIU · QS APPLICATION SYSTEM · RELEASED

passkey sign-in rolled out to production. "Continue with a passkey" is offered on every post-identifier sign-in screen, rolled out to production.

MyQS Core – Ph2

IN-77 · SYD1 · SYD1 · CHARLIE LIU · QS APPLICATION SYSTEM · SCOPING

Recruitment subgraph federated into the QS Supergraph in eu-west-2; Pulse production ingest API fronted with pulse.api.qs.com. The production ingest API is being fronted with pulse.api.qs.com. The Recruitment subgraph federated in the eu-west-2 estate from a snapshot of QAS-RecruitmentAdmin-GQL; federation delivery and schema release scoped to each estate's own subgraphs; Router readiness derived from the composed supergraph; and the migrate job entering the Recruitment app from CODEBUILD_SRC_DIR.

MyQS Design System

IN-26 · SYD1 · SYD1 · CHARLIE LIU · QS APPLICATION SYSTEM · BUILDING

Design System 2.1.35 through 2.1.39; AiChatBubble, header AI-assistant opt-in, product role revoke. 2.1.35 through 2.1.39: AiChatBubble and the header AI-assistant opt-in, revoking a product by answering No access on its role menu with the default seat reported back, and a concealed fixed panel kept hidden through its flyout animation.

MyQS MCP

IN-60 · SYD1 · SYD1 · CHARLIE LIU · QS APPLICATION SYSTEM · BUILDING

QS Agent opens from the header into a shell drawer; AiChatBubble published from the design-system root. Apps can now opt in to the header's AI assistant, and the QS Agent opens from the button into a shell drawer rather than a floating bubble. Caitlin published AiChatBubble from the design-system root, controllable by its host; Cerebrum adopted the drawer on 2.1.39 and dropped its two workarounds.

QS Application System

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

Dev estate tooling: Apps and products synced from production (eu-west-2) into dev (us-east-1) — 3 inserts, 13 updates, applied on 10 September with dev-after identical to production across 143 rows; local dev now runs over HTTPS on local.myqsapp.com and carries into promoted alphas, with dev-estate values shipped in .env.example and promote as their source of truth. Staging still to come. HolonIQ / HolonOS · with Caitlin Jiang and Ming Shi: Ranking and reputation report headers stick again while scrolling, promoted to qas-prod; two import cycles that crashed lazy routes were broken up, and Legacy Export was added to the Regional Rankings download menu; the hiq_internal sequence grant is recorded as applied on prod.

QS Application System

RISKS AND DECISIONS

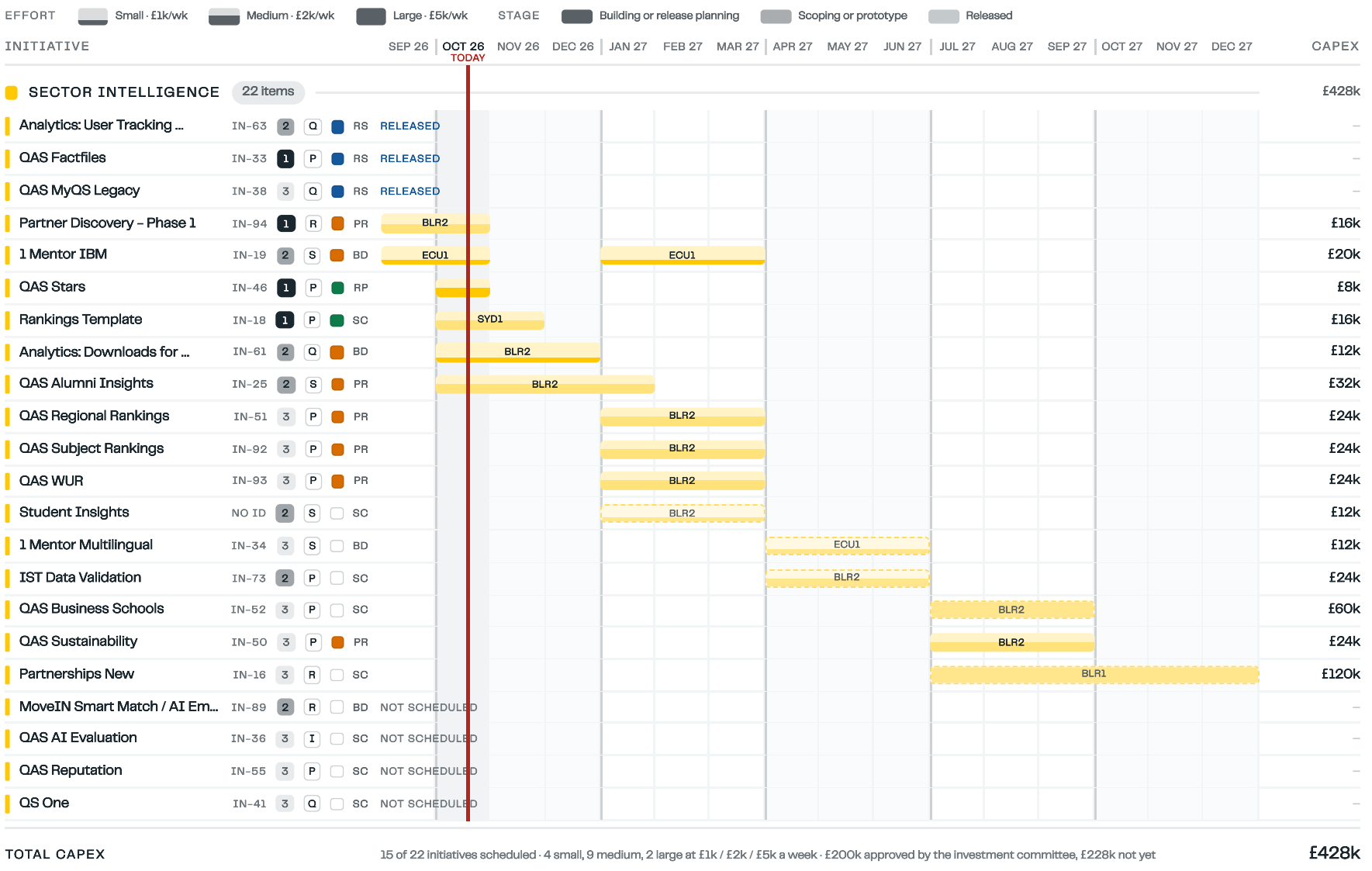
Risks and decisions. Customer account smart switching needs a decision. It resolves the confusion of customer accounts holding different subscriptions. QAS CX and HolonIQ user account migration QA is in progress — fixing subscription duplication, delta users and similar.

SECTION 3 OF 5

Sector Intelligence

4 initiatives reported

1 scoping
2 building
1 release planning



QAS Stars

IN-46 · BLR2 · BLR2 · SIMON HALL · RELEASE PLANNING

Stars ported to standalone QAS-native stack with GraphQL backend and Snowflake sync; multi-institution switcher; Portal guidance refinements. Ported the full Stars institution view (overview summary, category deep-dive, methodology) into the new standalone QAS front end and GraphQL backend. Migrated the Asset Library into the new stack with new schema and queries. Stood up the Stars GraphQL service (schema, data model, queries). Established data sync from Snowflake to keep the standalone service current. Added a multi-institution switcher for users managing multiple institutions. Refined star rating and score-range presentation in the existing Portal ahead of the port.

Risks and decisions. QAS Stars data copy. Decision needed on how data copy will be handled on the new QAS Stars stack.

1 Mentor IBM

IN-19 · ECU1 · ECU1 · JONNATHAN PENA · BUILDING

IBM platform certification for client demo; twelve items corrected and deployed to production. Completed and deployed to production, with certification for IBM as of 10 September: Career Goals Explore bug with occupation match and skill set; Wizard Step 2 goal recommendations not shown; Ikigai recommending occupations not included in the IBM catalogue; Career Goals Explore by Field bug with skill sets and match; Learning Paths Create My Path labels; Recommendations with no occupations recommended by skill set; landing page updated to Career Goals; Career Goals Explore 1M suggestions not shown; Explore by Career Field filter; LP My Paths two empty states; Wizard Step 1 institution limit; and Activate LP in Career Goals My Objectives.

MoveIN Smart Match / AI Email

IN-89 · MOVEIN · MOVEIN · MAHESH · BUILDING

Smart Match Assistant scan history and review workflows; AI Email Template Builder consistency and editing improvements. Teams can review AI matching activity more clearly through scan history, improved confirmation and rejection guidance and run-level performance visibility. Generated emails are more consistent across Outlook and Gmail; iterative editing, prompt history, spam checks and automated brand placement reduce manual effort.

Partnerships New

IN-16 · BLR2 · BLR2 · SIMON HALL · BLR1 · SIMON HALL · BLR1 · SCOPING

email template management; withdrawn-interest handling; filter improvements. BLR1: QPD institution eligibility and filtering. Delivered email templates management area for outreach. Added next/previous navigation on the opportunity detail page with position indicator. Added running total of applied filters on the apply action. Corrected per-section filter counts. Fixed QS Stars filtering so selecting a star category alone returns all rated institutions. Clarified collaboration readiness filter wording. Completed withdrawn-interest handling (IPS-2349): conversations tied to withdrawn interests are cleanly retired for both parties, with plain-language explanations for why replies are not possible, frozen conversation history and cleaned-up unread indicators.

Risks and decisions. QPD back-office is inaccessible on live. Decision needed on where this will live.

BLR2

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

MyQS dependency patching: Updated platform dependencies to patch vulnerabilities.

BLR1

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

HUB2: Progressed batch client publishing activities to support the rollout of institution updates and ensure approved changes are reflected across downstream systems. Continued QSA Directory enablement activities for a batch of clients. Investigated and progressed resolution efforts for the programme editing issue causing false "programme already opened in another tab" warnings. Continued analysis of the logo update issue in General Details, including investigation into potential Cloudflare-related impacts. Supported ongoing investigation of the Financial Aid bulk upload issue where uploaded data is not being reflected in the user interface despite successful processing.

ECU1

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

1 Mentor core fixes: Hid the provider filter when only one provider is available, and fixed matching issues in recommended occupations.

ECU2

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

General upkeep: Routine security patches on a few open-source packages flagged by the dependency scanner; no functional change.

MoveIN

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

Client evidence centralised in SharePoint (QS Stars): Shared storage reduces the risk of data loss and makes evidence easier for the team to access. MoveIN SSO infrastructure migrated: All Shibboleth (SSO) clients have transitioned off legacy hardware, improving reliability, performance and backup resilience. Scheduled task visibility and reminders: Users receive three days' notice before automations run and can track scheduled tasks directly from the MoveIN console. Platform reliability and security: Long-idle session issues fixed and essential security maintenance completed for the back-office interface.

MIMO

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

MoveON: Completed migration of OVH France and Telemaxx PlatformPHP2 servers to Ubuntu 24.04. MoveIN: Completed MoveIN Shibboleth migration from Telemaxx to AWS.

BLR2

RISKS AND DECISIONS

Risks and decisions. QPD back-office is inaccessible on live. Decision needed on where this will live. QAS Stars data copy. Decision needed on how data copy will be handled on the new QAS Stars stack.

ECU1

RISKS AND DECISIONS

Risks and decisions. Microsoft SSO for 1 Mentor staging. The team needs the ability to configure Microsoft SSO to access the staging environment using corporate accounts, enabling more accurate QA certification testing. Martin Ochoa may have details on the required Microsoft account configuration.

MoveIN

RISKS AND DECISIONS

Risks and decisions. OpenAI Assistants API deprecation. Support is being deprecated; alternatives are being assessed to avoid disruption to the Lumina assistant capability. RabbitMQ upgrade requires validation. The upgraded version is being monitored in the demo environment; if no further issues emerge, the live upgrade is planned for the coming weeks.

MIMO

RISKS AND DECISIONS

Risks and decisions. MoveON. PlatformPHP1 root-volume migration remains pending for OVH France and Telemaxx. Continued monitoring is required for the France MySQL environment following migration completion. Telemaxx MySQL cluster creation remains pending. MoveIN. RabbitMQ production upgrade remains pending approval and scheduling. Bitdefender legal documentation and approvals remain outstanding.

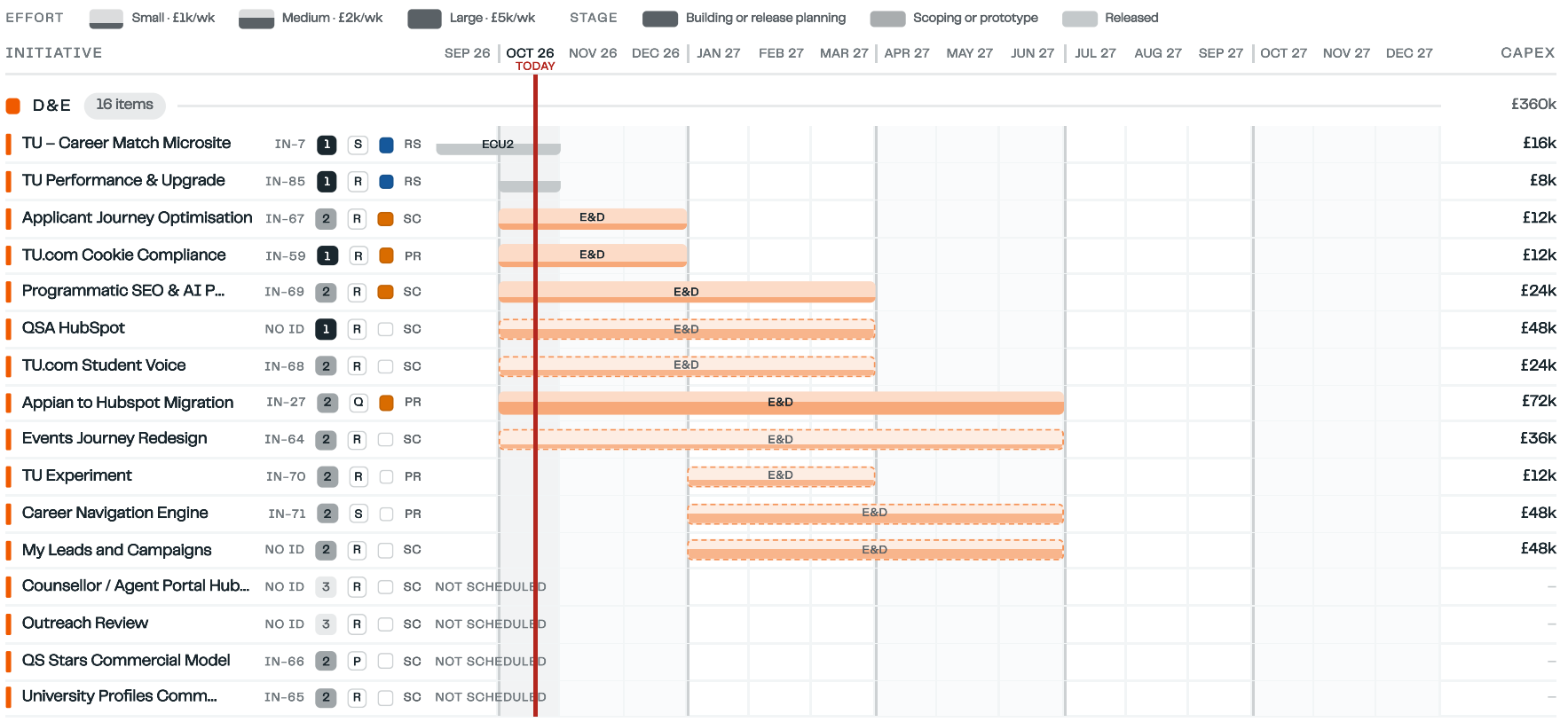
2027 Data and Engineering Delivery Plan

SECTION 4 OF 5

D&E

2 initiatives reported

2 released



TOTAL CAPEX — 12 of 16 initiatives scheduled · 6 small, 6 medium at £1k / £2k / £5k a week · £144k approved by the investment committee, £216k not yet — £360k

TU – Career Match Microsite

IN-7 · ECU2 · ECU2 · PAULA JIMINEZ · DIGITAL AND EVENTS · CATARINA CUNHA · DIGITAL AND EVENTS · RELEASED

server-side bot/scraper block; CSP validation; analytics accuracy fixes. D&E: CMT module conversion from React to Drupal. Shipped a server-side block that stops bots and scrapers from pulling quiz data directly, closing the gap the advisory-only rules (robots.txt, headers) could not close alone. Also passed Google's standard CSP security check and fixed a false positive blocking a legitimate embedded form. Automated tests now verify protections stay in place going forward. QA-verified. Signed off by the Tech Lead this week; design finalised. Fixed data-accuracy issues found in Product Owner review: option labels now show the actual text students saw (not internal codes), a stale-data leak on the homepage was fixed and a duplicate tracking event was eliminated. QA-verified across multiple test runs.

Risks and decisions. Microsite moving to urgent-only mode. Starting next week, the Microsite pod addresses only urgent and priority items; no further general feature work is queued.

TU Performance & Upgrade

IN-85 · D&E · DIGITAL AND EVENTS · CATARINA CUNHA · DIGITAL AND EVENTS · RELEASED

new server testing completed, release planned 17 September; TU performance investigation concluded; Drupal clean-up in validation. In validation for release next week. The investigation has been completed and based on it new tickets will be added to implement. Last testing phase has been completed. Planned release for next week.

Risks and decisions. new servers testing continues. Drupal upgrade: waiting for the new environment setup for the last round of testing.

Digital and Events

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

GME rankings: Ready for the release on the 16th. Agenda builder: Testing is ongoing. QS Future Forum: Ongoing as expected. Outreach V2 code removal and clean-up: Complete and released.

QS Apply (Appian)

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

Production support: Visa application status: resolved an issue where visa applications were displaying incorrect statuses, improving data accuracy and hygiene. Menu display issue: resolved an issue with a menu not displaying correctly following a recent Appian vendor software update. Lead allocation: investigated an issue where leads were not being distributed evenly across agents; confirmed no underlying system defect; configuration adjustments implemented and lead allocation now operating as expected.

D&E

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

Enabled Apsara RDS logging and confirmed the QS RMS (CN) issue reproduces on both RDS and standalone MySQL environments, indicating application-side optimisation is required.

2027 Data and Engineering Delivery Plan

ECU2

RISKS AND DECISIONS

Risks and decisions. Microsite moving to urgent-only mode. Starting next week, the Microsite pod addresses only urgent and priority items; no further general feature work is queued.

Digital and Events

RISKS AND DECISIONS

Risks and decisions. Angular upgrade. New servers testing continues. Drupal upgrade. Waiting now for the new environment setup for the last round of testing.

D&E

RISKS AND DECISIONS

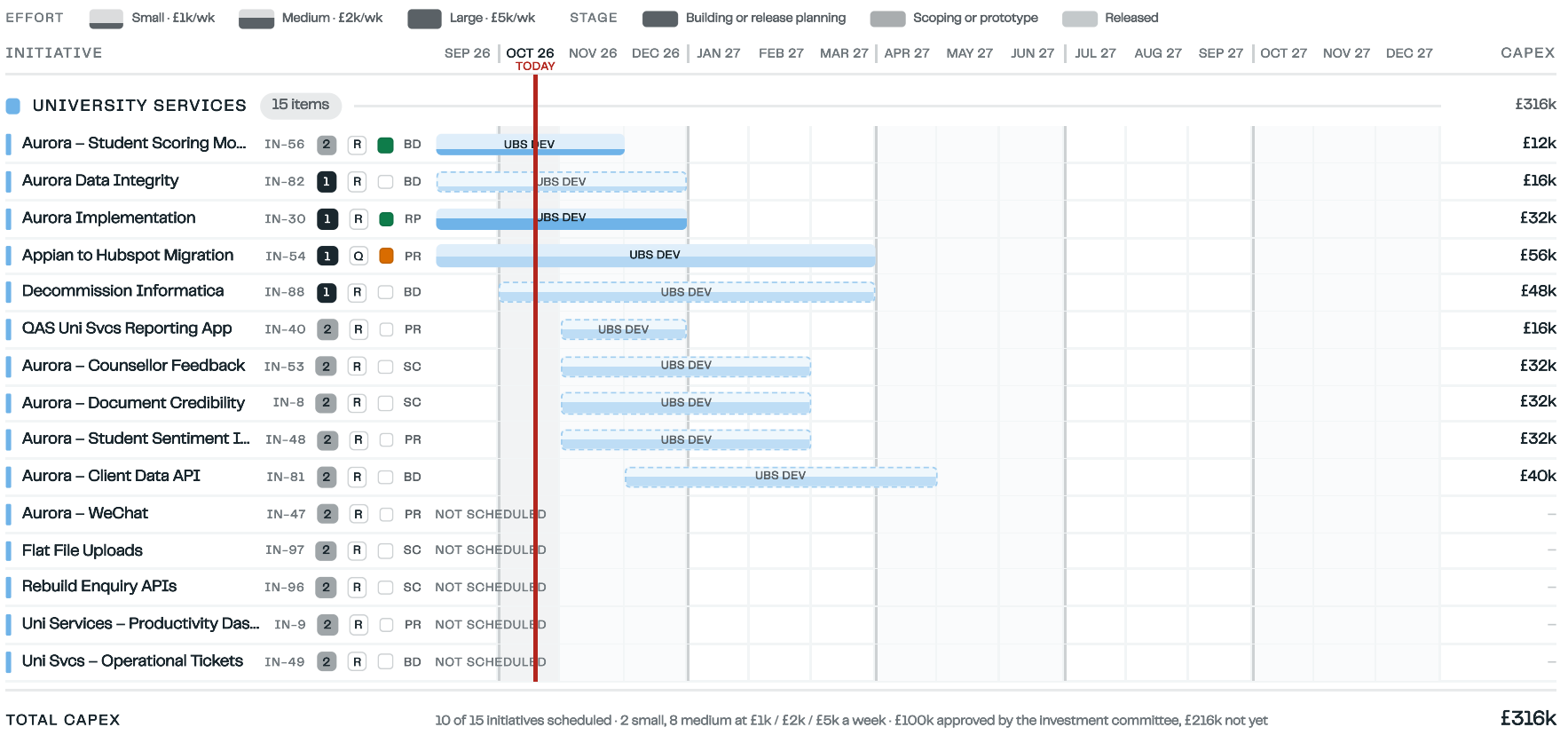
Risks and decisions. QSChina RMS CSV upload. Requires development-team optimisation. Automox. Approval remains pending with the DPO team. Bitdefender. Approval and legal documentation remain pending. Hub1 staging. Login issue remains under investigation.

SECTION 5 OF 5

University Services

3 initiatives reported

2 prototype
1 building



Appian to Hubspot Migration

IN-54 · QS APPLY · QS APPLY · SREERAM SREEKUMAR · UBS DEVELOPMENT · MOHD AZHAR MOHD RAZMAN · UBS DEVELOPMENT · QS APPLY (APPIAN) · PROTOTYPE

discovery workshops under way. UBS Development: enquiry API replacement commenced; ACU ready for testing, Keele and RCA under way. The discovery phase is now under way, with stakeholder workshops initiated to understand the current-state processes, system usage, pain points and opportunities for improvement across Lead Management and Admissions. Replacement for the first of ten clients (ACU) is ready for testing. Work has also commenced on replacements for two other clients (Keele and RCA).

Risks and decisions. HubSpot Contact Matching unavailable in test. Full integration testing cannot proceed until Contact Matching is available in the test environment.

Decommission Informatica

IN-88 · UBS DEVELOPMENT · UBS DEVELOPMENT · MOHD AZHAR MOHD RAZMAN · BUILDING

S3 flat-file replacements for Griffith, Brighton and Stirling; Keystone replacements for RCA and ECU. Griffith's replacement is awaiting deployment, pending API replacement. Brighton replacement has been developed and is awaiting testing. Stirling development work is under way. LSBU replacement work is paused, pending tender outcome. Two of three replacements (RCA and ECU) have been built in the test environment and are now ready for testing. Initial round of testing has concluded for RCA with a few small fixes needed.

Risks and decisions. Informatica contract ends 22 December 2026. Full decommissioning depends on finalising the York replacement, in discussion with Microsoft directly; Procurement has been advised in case the contract needs to extend. LSBU is paused pending tender outcome.

Uni Services – Productivity Dashboards

IN-9 · SYD1 · SYD1 · CHARLIE LIU · QS APPLICATION SYSTEM · PROTOTYPE

QS Recruitment Admin hardened for production, federated as a subgraph, Aircall sync as a scheduled Lambda, University Services dashboard served from graph.qs.com. Hardened for production and exposed as a federation subgraph, added to the eu-west-2 estate with its own database and RDS Proxy reachable through the SSM bastion, the Aircall sync running as a scheduled Lambda with a batched backfill ingest, and the University Services dashboard served from graph.qs.com.

UBS Development

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

Appian production support: Supported QS Apply with production fixes this week (see QS Apply section).

CX Systems

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

Aircall: onboarded new users; followed up with Support regarding the data provided by Sean from the Telco; currently awaiting their response. IVR: continued upgrades for the remaining universities; discussed Derby IVR enhancements with SS. Sakari: set up alphanumeric sender IDs for all existing universities; tested unregistered sender IDs with recipients in Nigeria and Vietnam; coordinated UAE sender IDs for specific universities; coordinated QS Events setup with Sebastian. Documentation: prepared handover and process documentation for Aircall and Twilio components currently in use. Niswey: coordinated to obtain the penetration-test report for the Compliance team; attended setup meeting with Sebastian.

UBS

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

Engaged key stakeholders to schedule September monthly maintenance for University Services AWS production infrastructure.

QS Application System

RISKS AND DECISIONS

Risks and decisions. Customer account smart switching needs a decision. It resolves the confusion of customer accounts holding different subscriptions. QAS CX and HolonIQ user account migration QA is in progress — fixing subscription duplication, delta users and similar.

UBS Development

RISKS AND DECISIONS

Risks and decisions. HubSpot Contact Matching unavailable in test. Full integration testing cannot proceed until Contact Matching is available in the test environment. The team is working to resolve this. University of London sandbox licensing. Missing required licensing to proceed with development. Simon is arranging access. LSBU paused. S3 flat-file integration on hold pending tender outcome. Informatica contract ends 22 December 2026.

CX Systems

RISKS AND DECISIONS

Risks and decisions. Sakari credentials. QS Events Sakari credentials are required. Sender ID validation. Performance will be validated through testing and production results. Sender IDs have already been set up for existing clients to monitor performance. Final results are expected once registration completes in the destination countries. SS documentation outstanding. Awaiting the required documentation and information from the SS team to complete sender ID registrations in each destination country.